

Fig 11.8: Food Sources of B_1

Symptoms of thiamine deficiency

- Loss of appetite, poor digestion.
- Muscular weakness and feeling tired
- Insomnia, mental depression,
- Loss of weight, leg cramps
- Digestive disorders
- Slow heart beat and
- Gastrointestinal problems

Deficiency Diseases

Thiamine deficiency causes Beriberi and there are three kinds of Beriberi

a) **Dry Beriberi** affects the nervous system, causing tingling and loss of sensation that may lead to limb paralysis and degeneration of nervous tissues. There is difficulty in walking. Foot and wrist drop also results.

b) **Wet Beriberi** affects the heart. There is difficulty in breathing. It enlarges the heart causing painful palpitations, disfunctioning of heart and heart attack.

c) **Infantile Beri** occurs in infants who cry without sound. Infants have difficulty in breathing, The body turns blue and may lead to death within 24-28 hrs.

It also leads to poor functioning of gastrointestinal tract and poor appetite.

11.3.2 Vitamin B_2 (Riboflavin)

Riboflavin is a water soluble and relatively heat stable vitamin. It is easily absorbed from the intestine and the excess is excreted through the urine. It is essential for the health of skin and for normal vision.

Functions

- Riboflavin plays an important role in the health of the eyes and alleviates eye strain and is essential for proper vision and healthy sight.

UNIT-11_174-207.indd 181 23-01-2020 10:18:31